How this report was prepared, and the sources behind it

Methodology

Scope. Privacy infrastructure for public blockchains across four layers: network, computation, applications, and payments and assets.

Evidence. Public investor research, project documentation, court records and regulatory releases. Figures are as published and not adjusted for overlap.

Illustrative data. Modelled or hypothetical figures carry a sand Illustrative data tag and are not forecasts.

Assessments. Qualitative ratings and placements are Khala Research judgements and are labelled as such.

Disclosures

[Placeholder] Holdings, conflicts of interest and compensation to be confirmed before publication. This draft is for internal review and is not investment advice.

References

a16z crypto, State of Crypto 2025 (Oct 2025)

a16z, Investing in Nym

Multicoin Capital, 2026 investment thesis (Feb 2026) *(link to add)*

CoinDesk, Nillion raises $25M led by Hack VC (Oct 2024)

Vitalik Buterin, Why I support privacy (Apr 2025)

Vitalik Buterin, A maximally simple L1 privacy roadmap

Cointelegraph, Telegram will exit markets before adding backdoors: Durov

Telegram, End-to-end encryption FAQ

Zama, The first confidential payroll on Ethereum mainnet (with Bron)

Coin Metrics, State of the Network 338 (18 Nov 2025)

The Block, Zcash shielded supply hits 4.5M ZEC (29 Oct 2025)

Blockworks Advisory, Zcash token holder report Q2 2026

Blockworks Advisory, Zcash token holder report Q1 2026

Delphi Digital, $NOCK (13 Oct 2025) *(link to add)*

UR, subnet design and implementation; URnetwork, threat model *(link to add)*

US Treasury, sanctions on Tornado Cash (8 Aug 2022)

Willkie Farr, United States removes sanctions against Tornado Cash (Mar 2025)

Fifth Circuit, Van Loon v. Department of the Treasury (26 Nov 2024)

GENIUS Act, S.1582, 119th Congress (Jul 2025)

Bitcoin Magazine, Roman Storm found guilty of one of three counts (Aug 2025)

Aleo, Paxos Labs and the Aleo Network Foundation launch USAD

Bittensor, The Bittensor Paradigm

Note: Draft reference list. Confirm titles, dates and links against the originals before publication.